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Targeting VP of Design at Series A/B companies · Remote from New Delhi (US/EU overlap) · Open to relocation

POSITIONING

Head of Design | I build autonomous, AI-native design engines that deliver business outcomes without executive hand-holding.

I ran design as a company-level function at Cypherock, a crypto hardware wallet startup, from pre-launch beta through its first million in revenue. I partnered with the C-suite as a strategic peer to shape the product infrastructure, assuming total accountability for every customer-facing surface across hardware, desktop, and mobile. My leadership style is systems-first. I build the architecture, AI-augmented workflows, and decision processes so the design engine runs autonomously and predictably at scale. I am looking for a Series A/B company where design reports directly to the founder and operates with zero hand-holding and absolute accountability to business outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

OrbitWatch · AI Geospatial Intelligence Platform

Consulting VP of Design · March 2026 to August 2026

Operated as an autonomous executive consultant to architect the product design strategy for a "Zero-Pilot" geospatial intelligence platform. Partnered with stakeholders to establish a verified "Physical Truth" interface that bypasses spoofed maritime transponders and regional data blackouts.

- Executive UX Strategy: Directed the end-to-end design architecture for the platform's core "Gap Engine," translating complex Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) telemetry and multimodal AI reasoning into a scalable, zero-error tactical interface for defense analysts and commodity traders.
- Systemic Cognitive Load Management: Established the design standards and cognitive load thresholds for visualizing massive data lakes. Defined the high-contrast, dark-mode architectural frameworks (Next.js, Mapbox) that allowed users to verify physical radar footprints without interface paralysis.
- AI Edge-Case Architecture: Built the foundational UI logic to interpret and visualize advanced AI outputs—including Double-Bounce Reflection Analysis and Shadow Volumetric Modeling. This structural framework empowered users to instantly identify dark fleet evasion and manipulated stockpile volumes.
- Lean Operations: Delivered complete foundational product design and system architecture as an independent consultant, enabling the company to scale its core intelligence platform without adding permanent in-house design headcount.

Cypherock · Crypto hardware wallet startup (cypherock.com)

Head of Design · July 2022 to January 2026 · Worked directly with CEO and CTO

Joined pre-launch: a placeholder website, a rudimentary hardware design, a proof-of-concept companion app, and zero customers. Partnered with the CEO and CTO to define the product ecosystem itself, then owned the design of all three customer touchpoints (X1 hardware wallet, CySync desktop and mobile software, marketing website) through launch and scale.

- Drove user adoption and market trust by architecting the complete customer-facing ecosystem (hardware, desktop, mobile), directly contributing to $1.16M in ARR (15% MoM growth) and unlocking H1 FY26 projections of $2.5M.
- Led the crypto inheritance feature from conception to deployment as the decision-making design owner, working directly with the CEO. At my departure it was the strongest inheritance offering in the hardware wallet market. A category-defining feature for a product whose entire value is what happens to assets under worst-case scenarios.
- Architected the company's design system twice. V1 unified website and software at launch. V2, VikSchema, is a responsibility-driven architecture that separates structure, styling, layout, and context into independent layers, with a progressive token system and a one-to-one mapping between design layers and engineering implementation. It gave design and engineering a shared system language, and it's built to carry multiple brands and products, not one.
- Directed an elastic, multi-disciplinary network of external contractors (3D/animation artists, product photographers), enforcing strict quality control and brand parity across all surfaces without adding full-time headcount bloat.
- Designed CySync from the ground up: full user flows for hardware-software communication, error and edge-case handling for security-critical operations, and all interface graphics. Shipped new features on a fortnightly cadence for three years against that same system.
- Independently designed CySync Mobile v2, taking a data-heavy crypto dashboard from a reduced companion app to full 1:1 parity with desktop, one of the harder information-architecture problems in the category.
- Contributed to the industrial design of the X1 hardware itself: product form, packaging, and materials selection alongside the hardware team.
- Delivered the white-label program: customized X1 hardware and CySync for Odix Pay and supported bulk B2B and reseller deals, the first proof that the design foundation could carry a second brand.
- Designed and shipped the marketing website in my first months, working with the CEO on copy and flow. The site has run unchanged since launch: a design decision that has held for over three years.
- Built the investor narrative surfaces: designed the fundraise decks for both Cypherock and CyChain, the company's follow-on decentralized custody network, which signed LOIs with on-chain treasury managers representing over $3.5B AUM.

Aryaink · Design agency, Delhi · January 2012 to July 2022

A decade at one agency where my responsibility, and compensation, grew continuously while titles stayed informal. I started in brand and communication design and ended running multiple design teams in parallel, each on a different client engagement.

- By my final years, single-handedly directed several concurrent teams of researchers, designers, analysts, and engineers for clients worldwide, owning product design and branding from concept through implementation, on time and on budget across multiphase projects
- Mentored junior designers into leads across those teams, and operated as the bridge between design and engineering: ran creative workshops with clients, translated outcomes into buildable concepts, and kept designers and software teams aligned through delivery.
- Built the two skill sets Cypherock later required at once: creative direction (brand, communication, directing multidisciplinary creatives) and deep product craft (flows, interfaces, shipped software).

SYSTEMS I'VE BUILT

Working inside a scaling startup, I watched the same structural gaps cost time, money, and outcomes again and again: systems that drift, decisions that get re-litigated, knowledge that lives in one person's head, hiring that runs on gut feel. I built an instrument for each one.

VikShema

A responsibility-driven design system architecture, built and deployed as Cypherock's v2 system. Organizes by responsibility rather than complexity, so components have clear boundaries, dependencies flow one way, and the same foundation scales across products and brands. Closes the gap of design systems that fragment as they grow.

AI-Facilitated Design Review Protocol

A decision-facilitation system where AI acts as facilitator, not reviewer: it converts opinion into evidence and measures time-to-confident-decision instead of comment volume. Closes the gap of reviews that run on taste and meetings that re-litigate settled questions.

VikSense

A custom GPT that turns a design org's tacit knowledge into onboarding, tutorials, and first-pass design review that anyone on the team can use. Closes the gap of expertise trapped in senior people's heads, the bottleneck that makes design teams scale badly.

Handsoff

A Figma plugin that generates component documentation from the components themselves, so a growing system stays trustworthy instead of drifting out of date. Closes the gap of documentation that is obsolete the week after it's written.

Throughline (throughline.vikals.com)

A hiring evaluation meta-system for design roles, written rigorously enough that a team can run it without me. Closes the gap of design hiring that runs on portfolio vibes instead of evidence.

The thesis running through all five

AI computes and recommends, humans hold the gate. And a system isn't finished until it works without its author present.

HOW I OPERATE

- Design answers for business outcomes. At Cypherock the question was never "is the screen done," it was "does a first-time user trust this device with their savings."
- I lead through systems and standards, not through presence. The design system, the review discipline, and the decision records were how one design function held quality across hardware, software, web, and a contractor bench simultaneously.
- I hold the quality gate personally on trust-critical surfaces (recovery, inheritance, hardware-software handshake) and delegate the rest with clear decision rights.